

Question 17 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Identify any two indicators of a supportive HRD climate.

Introduction

An indicator is a sign you can see, hear or measure, which tells you that the HRD climate is supportive. Climate itself is a perception — ‘how it feels to work here regarding development’. Indicators make that perception visible. For 8 marks, name two indicators in depth, explain what you would actually observe, and then mention other valid indicators from OCTAPAC-type values (openness, confrontation, trust, autonomy, proactivity, authenticity, collaboration).

Detailed points

1. First indicator — openness and free, useful feedback. In a supportive climate, employees can share doubts, ideas and even disagreement without being labelled ‘negative’. Feedback is regular, specific and two-way: the boss tells the employee about work, and the employee can tell the boss about obstacles. You would observe meetings where juniors speak, mistakes being discussed to learn (not only to punish), and people not waiting a full year to know whether they are doing well.

2. How to use this indicator (examples). A climate survey item such as ‘I can discuss problems with my superior without fear’ scores high. Suggestion schemes are actually used. After a failed project, the team holds an after-action talk. If instead people stay silent in meetings and gossip later, openness is absent — climate is not supportive even if the canteen is good.

3. Second indicator — visible management support for development. Supportive climate is not only polite talk; leaders give time, money and sponsorship for learning. Bosses release staff for training and then help them apply it. Development is discussed in performance reviews. Leaders themselves admit they are still learning. If every training is cancelled because ‘work is busy’, the true indicator is lack of support, whatever the HR poster says.

4. How to observe the second indicator. Look at training days actually attended, percentage of individual development plans completed, budget not frozen at the first sign of lower profit, and whether distant-branch staff also get chances. Support that exists only at head office is not a healthy organisational HRD climate.

5. Other important indicators you should add after the two. Trust (people believe words match actions). Authenticity (people need not wear a mask). Autonomy and proactivity (reasonable freedom and initiative). Collaboration (departments help rather than fight). Confrontation of problems (issues are solved, not buried). Fairness (women, juniors, and less ‘favourite’ staff also get development). Recognition of mentoring and knowledge sharing, not only of individual heroes.

6. Teamwork as a practical indicator. If a production problem is jointly solved by production, quality and maintenance without blame letters first, collaboration climate is present. If every problem becomes a war of notes, climate is weak.

7. Why indicators matter. HRD mechanisms (appraisal, training) work only in a supportive climate. Indicators help diagnose whether the soil is alive. They also help the student write a concrete answer instead of repeating the word ‘good climate’.

8. Exam caution. Do not only list OCTAPAC as seven words. For each chosen indicator, write: meaning + what you would see + one example. That is how ‘identify any two’ becomes 8 marks.

Conclusion. Two strong indicators are (1) openness with free, useful feedback and (2) visible management support for development (time, money, sponsorship). Explain observable signs, then mention trust, fairness and collaboration. Indicators diagnose climate; slogans do not.